

UNESCO City of Film is a designation awarded by UNESCO under the UNESCO Creative Cities Network (UCCN) to cities that demonstrate a significant contribution to the development of film as a creative industry and as a driver of sustainable urban development. Established in 2009, the designation recognises cities with a strong tradition of filmmaking, film education, preservation of cinematic heritage, and support for the audiovisual industry.

Cities of Film cooperate internationally by exchanging expertise, promoting cultural diversity, supporting filmmakers and creative professionals, and developing projects that strengthen the role of cinema in education, tourism, economic development, and public life.

Film is one of eight creative fields in the UNESCO Creative Cities Network, the others are: Architecture, Crafts and Folk Art, Design, Gastronomy, Literature, Media Arts, and Music.

Criteria

To be approved as a City of Film, cities need to meet a number of criteria set by UNESCO.

Designated UNESCO Cities of Film share similar characteristics:

important infrastructure related to cinema, e.g. film studios and film landscapes/environments

continuous or proven links to the production, distribution, and commercialisation of films

experience in hosting film festivals, screenings, and other film-related events

collaborative initiatives at a local, regional, and international level

film heritage in the form of archives, museums, private collections, and/or film institutes

film making schools and training centres

effort in disseminating films produced and/or directed locally or nationally

initiatives to encourage knowledge-sharing on foreign films

About the cities

Bradford became the first City of Film in 2009, with Sydney joining in 2010. Sydney is home to Fox Studios Australia, the studio that brought The Matrix trilogy, The Great Gatsby, and The Wolverine to life. Its "pristine beaches" and "lush mountains" can also provide a backdrop for location shooting.

Busan hosts an annual International Film Festival and is a "standard-setter" in the film world.

Bristol is home to the Academy award-winning Aardman Animations. It is also home to The Bottle Yard Studios and the BBC Natural History Unit. Bristol is "packed with history and full of character," Yamagata is a "pleasant, bustling rural capital."

Yamagata hosts every two years an International Documentary Film Festival.

Potsdam is home to Babelsberg Studio, the largest film studio in Germany. It is also home to Film Park of Babelsberg and Film University of Babelsberg.

Mumbai is home to Hindi cinema.

Cities of Film

As of 2025, four countries have multiple Cities of Film: Brazil has three Cities of Film; Poland, Spain and the United Kingdom (specifically England) have two each.

See also

Creative Cities Network

City of Literature

City of Music

Design Cities

City of Crafts and Folk Arts

City of Gastronomy

City of Media Arts

References

External links

The Creative Cities Network: Film (unesco.org)